

Patient Rights and Responsibilities

Policy Number	POL-CMP-083	Owner / Department	Administration / Patient Experience
Effective Date	2023-06-15	Version	2.2
Last Revised	2026-04-20	Next Review	2028-04-20
Approved By	Patient Experience Committee	Applies To	All patients and their representatives; all staff and licensed providers

1. Purpose

This policy affirms the rights of every patient at Riverside Regional Medical Center and the responsibilities of staff to honor them, consistent with the CMS Condition of Participation on patient rights (42 CFR 482.13). Patients are informed of their rights in advance of furnishing or discontinuing care wherever possible.

2. Patient Rights

- To be informed of their rights and to exercise them without coercion, discrimination, or reprisal.
- To participate in care decisions, give or withhold informed consent, and formulate advance directives.
- To personal privacy, confidentiality of records, and care in a safe setting.
- To be free from restraint or seclusion imposed for coercion, discipline, convenience, or retaliation.
- To access their medical records and to voice grievances about care without fear of reprisal.

3. Patient Responsibilities

- Provide accurate and complete health information.
- Ask questions when instructions or the plan of care are not understood.
- Treat staff and other patients with respect and follow facility conduct and safety rules.
- Meet financial obligations as arranged with the facility.

4. Informing Patients of Rights

Patients receive a written statement of rights and the Notice of Privacy Practices at or before admission, in a language and format they understand. Staff direct patients to language-access services per POL-CMP-084 when needed, and to the grievance process per POL-CMP-082.

IMPORTANT — A patient's refusal of care, request to leave against medical advice, or withdrawal of consent must be honored and documented immediately, with the attending provider notified at once. Never use restraint to prevent a competent patient from leaving.

5. Severity & Reporting

Violations of patient rights are classified on the facility-wide scale in POL-RM-013. An event involving abuse, neglect, or inappropriate restraint resulting in serious harm or death is SEV-1 (notify the Administrator-on-Call and Risk Management within 1 hour). A major rights violation without serious harm is SEV-2 (notify the manager and Risk Management within 4 hours). A minor lapse is SEV-3 (report within 24 hours).

6. References

- CMS Conditions of Participation, 42 CFR 482.13 (patient's rights).
- Related: POL-CMP-082 (Grievance), POL-CMP-084 (Language Access), POL-HIM-080 (HIPAA Privacy), POL-RM-013 (severity & reporting).